Website Builders with Custom Domain Support: Free and Under $5 Plans (2026)

Executive Summary

As of October 2026, only 4 website builders allow small businesses to connect a custom domain on a genuinely free plan: Dorik, Google Sites, HubSpot CMS, and Kit (formerly ConvertKit).

For under-$5/month plans, the cheapest option is **Carrd at $1.58/month ($19/year)** for single-page sites, followed by **IONOS at $1/month introductory** (renews at $14-20/month), and **Hostinger at $2.99/month** for full-featured websites (48-month commitment required).

Most popular builders (Wix, Squarespace, Webflow, WordPress.com) require paid plans starting at $14-$17/month to connect a custom domain.

Free Plans with Custom Domain Support

Platform	Price	Pages/Sites	Key Features	Main Limitations
Dorik	**$0**	Unlimited pages, unlimited websites	Unlimited storage, bandwidth, blog posts, 120+ templates, CMS (10 collections)	Platform branding, no collaborators, AI limited to 2 generations
Google Sites	**$0**	Unlimited pages, 1 domain	Google Workspace integration, drag-and-drop editor, no storage limits	No blog, no ecommerce, no SEO tools, ~10 basic templates only
HubSpot CMS	**$0**	Up to 30 pages, 1 domain	Blog, built-in CRM, email automation (2,000 emails/month), AI content assistant, SEO tools	HubSpot branding on all pages, domain must be under 64 characters
Kit	**$0**	Landing pages only, 1 domain	Email marketing (10,000 subscribers), unlimited emails, digital product sales, paid newsletters	Not a full website builder, landing pages only, no multi-page sites

Sources: Dorik (dorik.com/blog/best-free-website-builders-with-custom-domain), MakingThatWebsite (makingthatwebsite.com/free-website-builder-with-custom-domain/)

Under $5/Month Plans with Custom Domain Support

Platform	Price (Annual Billing)	Pages/Features	Best For	Renewal Cost
Carrd	**$1.58/month ($19/year)**	Single page only, custom domain, premium URLs	One-page portfolios, landing pages	$19/year (same)
IONOS	**$1/month (intro)**	Unlimited pages, 400+ templates, AI builder, email, SSL, ecommerce	Small business websites	$14-20/month
Hostinger Premium	**$2.99/month**	100 websites, unlimited storage/bandwidth, AI tools	WordPress websites	$10.99/month
Hostinger Business	**$3.99/month**	100 websites, unlimited storage/bandwidth, ecommerce, AI tools	WordPress and ecommerce sites	$16.99/month
DreamHost	**$2.89/month**	WordPress hosting, unlimited bandwidth, SSL	WordPress websites	not found

Sources: Toolradar (toolradar.com/guides/cheapest-website-builders), Tech.co (tech.co/website-builders/best-cheap-website-builder), Fit Small Business (fitsmallbusiness.com/cheap-website-builder/)

Detailed Platform Analysis

Free Plan Options

1. Dorik — Best Overall Free Plan

Price: $0 (genuinely free forever)

Custom domains: Unlimited custom domains with free SSL certificates via Let's Encrypt

What's included:

- Unlimited websites, pages, and blog posts
- Unlimited storage and bandwidth with no pageview limits
- 120+ professionally designed templates and 250+ UI blocks
- AI website generation (limited to 2 uses on free plan)
- Built-in CMS with 10 collections and unlimited items per site
- Contact forms, subscription forms, and payment buttons
- Global CDN for fast page loading worldwide

Limitations:

- Dorik branding displayed on published sites (removable on paid plans)
- 0 collaborators per site (solo use only)
- No code export on free plan
- AI website generation capped at 2 uses

Upgrade path: Pro plan at $39/month removes branding and adds 10 collaborators

Source: https://dorik.com/blog/best-free-website-builders-with-custom-domain

2. Google Sites — Simplest Free Option

Price: $0 (completely free, no paid tier exists)

Custom domains: 1 custom domain via DNS configuration

What's included:

- Unlimited pages with no storage limits
- Drag-and-drop document-style interface
- Direct integration with Google Calendar, Docs, Sheets, Forms, Maps, YouTube
- Real-time collaboration with other Google account users
- Automatic mobile-responsive layouts
- Minimal platform branding (small "i" icon only)

Limitations:

- No blogging functionality
- No ecommerce features
- No CMS or content management system
- Limited to approximately 10 basic templates with minimal customization
- No SEO tools (no sitemap control, no meta description editing, no schema markup)

- No native contact forms (must embed Google Forms separately)
- No analytics integration without manual code injection

Best for: Internal team sites, school projects, simple informational pages for users already in Google Workspace ecosystem

Source: https://dorik.com/blog/best-free-website-builders-with-custom-domain

3. HubSpot CMS — Free Marketing Platform

Price: $0 (free Content Hub plan)

Custom domains: 1 custom domain with free SSL

What's included:

- Up to 30 website pages maximum
- Drag-and-drop page editor with templates from HubSpot and ThemeForest marketplace
- Blog functionality with AI content assistant
- Built-in CRM with contact tracking and visitor analytics
- Email marketing automation with up to 2,000 emails per month to 2,500 subscribers
- Forms, live chat, and chatbot builders
- SEO recommendations engine
- Team inbox for customer support

Limitations:

- HubSpot branding appears on all pages (requires paid plan to remove)
- Domain must be under 64 characters total including subdomain
- Only 1 email automation workflow on free plan
- Steep pricing jump after free plan ($18/month minimum, enterprise features cost $1,600+/month)

Best for: Small businesses needing a marketing site with built-in CRM and email automation tools

Sources: https://www.makingthatwebsite.com/free-website-builder-with-custom-domain/, https://dorik.com/blog/best-free-website-builders-with-custom-domain

4. Kit (ConvertKit) — Landing Pages for Newsletters

Price: $0 (free Newsletter plan)

Custom domains: 1 custom domain for landing pages

What's included:

- Unlimited landing pages (sign-up pages, webinar pages, waitlists, product sales pages)
- Send unlimited emails to up to 10,000 subscribers (most generous free email plan in 2026)
- Digital product sales with customizable sales pages
- Paid newsletter functionality with monthly subscription fees
- Limited landing page templates designed primarily for email capture

Limitations:

- Cannot build a multi-page website (landing pages only)
- No blog functionality
- Limited design customization beyond content changes
- Expensive upgrade costs after exceeding 10,000 subscribers ($99/month vs. competitors at $65/month)

Best for: Newsletter creators and online course creators who need landing pages to grow an email list

Source: https://www.makingthatwebsite.com/free-website-builder-with-custom-domain/

Under $5/Month Options

1. Carrd — Cheapest Custom Domain Solution

Price: $19/year ($1.58/month) for Pro Standard plan

Custom domains: Full custom domain support with SSL

What's included:

- Single-page website only (one-page layout)
- Premium URLs and custom domain connection
- Ad-free experience (ads removed)
- Free plan allows up to 3 sites with no time limit on carrd.co subdomain

Limitations:

- Pro Lite tier at $9/year does not include custom domain support
- Single-page layout only; not suitable for multi-page business sites or blogs
- Limited to portfolio sites, landing pages, or simple one-page presentations

Rating: 4.5/5 based on 62 reviews (G2: 4.5/34 reviews, Capterra: 4.6/28 reviews)

Best for: One-page portfolios, personal sites, and single landing pages requiring minimal cost

Source: https://toolradar.com/guides/cheapest-website-builders

2. IONOS — Best Under-$5 Introductory Deal

Introductory price: $1/month for first year

Renewal price: $14/month (Starter) to $20/month (Plus)

Custom domains: Free domain, SSL certificate, and business email included

What's included:

- Unlimited pages on one website
- 400+ professionally designed templates
- AI-powered website builder and copywriting tools
- Built-in email marketing tools
- rankingCoach SEO feature for search optimization
- Google PageSpeed optimization and global CDN
- Booking tools and ecommerce support on Plus plan
- Dedicated consultant and 24/7 support

Limitations:

- No free plan or trial period
- Price increases significantly after first year ($14-20/month renewal)
- No ecommerce dropshipping features

Best for: Small businesses willing to commit to a one-year introductory period who need full business features including email hosting

Source: https://fitsmallbusiness.com/cheap-website-builder/

3. Hostinger — Best Value Under $5

Price: $2.99/month (Premium plan, 48-month contract) or $3.99/month (Business plan, 48-month contract)

Renewal price: $10.99/month (Premium) or $16.99/month (Business)

Custom domains: Free domain for first year, unlimited SSL certificates

What's included:

- 100 websites with unlimited storage and bandwidth
- AI-powered website generator creates site in 30 seconds
- AI tools including content generator, heatmap analysis, and logo maker
- Built-in SEO Assistant for better search rankings
- Ecommerce support with 0% transaction fees (from Business plan)
- 20+ payment processing options including Google Ads and Facebook Ads integrations
- WordPress and WooCommerce support

Limitations:

- Lowest pricing requires 48-month (4-year) upfront commitment
- No free plan (7-day free trial available)
- Ecommerce limited to 500 products without WooCommerce hosting upgrade
- Limited third-party app integrations

Special deal: $2.69/month (Premium) or $3.59/month (Business) with code TECH (48-month contract)

Best for: Small businesses and ecommerce stores that can commit to longer-term plans and want AI-assisted building tools

Sources: https://tech.co/website-builders/best-cheap-website-builder, https://fitsmallbusiness.com/cheap-website-builder/

4. DreamHost

Price: $2.89/month

Custom domains: Included

What's included:

- WordPress hosting with unlimited bandwidth
- Free SSL certificate
- One-click WordPress installation
- Email hosting for limited time

Limitations:

- Technical knowledge helpful for WordPress management
- Limited ecommerce tools without plugins
- More suitable for users comfortable with WordPress

Best for: Budget-conscious WordPress users who need basic hosting

Source: https://fitsmallbusiness.com/cheap-website-builder/

Platforms That Do NOT Offer Free/Under-$5 Custom Domain Plans

The following popular website builders require paid plans starting at $14-$29/month to connect a custom domain:

Platform	Minimum Price for Custom Domain	Free Plan Available?
Wix	$17/month (Light plan)	Yes, but with wixsite.com subdomain only
Squarespace	$16/month (Basic plan, annual billing)	No (14-day free trial only)
Webflow	$15/month (Basic Site plan, annual billing)	Yes, but webflow.io subdomain only
Shopify	$29/month (Basic plan)	No (3-day free trial, $1/month for first 3 months promo)
Weebly	$13/month (Professional plan)	Yes, but with Weebly subdomain
Framer	$10/month (Basic plan, annual billing)	Yes, but framer.website subdomain only
Tilda	$10/month (Personal plan, annual billing)	Yes, but 1 website max on free plan

Sources: https://toolradar.com/guides/cheapest-website-builders, https://tech.co/website-builders/best-cheap-website-builder

Key Considerations and Hidden Limitations

Common Free Plan Restrictions

- **Platform branding:** Most free plans display provider branding on your site (e.g., "Built with Dorik" or "Powered by HubSpot")
- **Storage limits:** Free plans may cap storage at 1-10 GB, though Dorik and Google Sites offer unlimited storage
- **Bandwidth limits:** Some platforms cap monthly bandwidth or pageviews (though most allow reasonable small business traffic)
- **No ecommerce:** Most free plans do not include ecommerce checkout functionality
- **Limited SEO tools:** Advanced SEO features typically require paid upgrades
- **No email hosting:** Free plans rarely include business email addresses
- **Ads:** Some free builders (like Wix free plan) may display ads, though most of the options listed here do not

Under-$5 Plan Pricing Traps

- **Renewal price increases:** IONOS jumps from $1/month intro to $14-20/month renewal; Hostinger from $2.99 to $10.99/month (Premium) or $3.99 to $16.99/month (Business)
- **Long commitment required:** Hostinger's lowest rates require 48-month (4-year) commitment; most builders require annual billing for advertised rates
- **Domain registration separate:** Some platforms include first-year domain free but charge $10-15/year afterward

- **Transaction fees:** Ecommerce features may charge 2-5% transaction fees on sales, plus payment processor fees
- **Email costs extra:** Business email hosting often costs additional $5-10/month unless included (IONOS includes it)

Technical Requirements

- **DNS configuration:** All custom domain setups require access to domain registrar DNS settings to add A records or CNAME records
- **SSL certificates:** All platforms listed provide free SSL certificates via Let's Encrypt or similar
- **Propagation time:** DNS changes take 1-48 hours to propagate globally after configuration

Recommendations by Use Case

Business Type	Recommended Platform	Reason
Simple informational site (hours, location, contact)	Google Sites (free)	Completely free, unlimited pages, integrates with Google Workspace
Small business website with blog	Dorik (free) or HubSpot (free)	Both offer blogs; HubSpot adds CRM and email marketing; Dorik offers unlimited everything
Portfolio or landing page	Carrd ($1.58/month)	Cheapest paid option for single-page sites with custom domain
Email newsletter creator	Kit (free)	10,000 free subscribers with unlimited emails plus landing page with custom domain
Ecommerce store	Hostinger Business ($3.99/month)	0% transaction fees, 500 products, full ecommerce features under $5
Multi-site business	Dorik (free)	Only free option allowing unlimited websites with custom domains
Business needing email hosting	IONOS ($1/month intro)	Includes free business email, domain, SSL in one package

Summary of Findings

Free plans with custom domain support are rare. Only 4 platforms genuinely allow custom domains at $0: Dorik, Google Sites, HubSpot CMS, and Kit. Each has significant limitations — Google Sites lacks blogging and ecommerce, HubSpot caps pages at 30, and Kit only offers landing pages.

Dorik offers the most generous free plan with unlimited websites, pages, storage, and bandwidth. However, it displays platform branding and limits collaboration to solo use.

For under $5/month, Carrd is cheapest at $1.58/month but only supports single-page sites. For full-featured websites under $5, Hostinger ($2.99-3.99/month) and IONOS ($1/month introductory) provide the best value, though both require annual commitments and increase significantly at renewal.

Most mainstream website builders (Wix, Squarespace, Webflow) do not offer custom domain support below $14-17/month, despite marketing "free" plans. Their free tiers force platform subdomains.

Hidden costs to watch: Renewal price increases (IONOS jumps 1,400% from intro to renewal), long commitment requirements (Hostinger requires 48 months for lowest rate), separate domain registration fees after year one, and transaction fees on ecommerce sales.

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